Project 3: the letters (the Sumerian letters of private life; ETCSL 5.5.1 and 3.3.x)

Scope

The Message of Lu-diĝira to his mother (ETCSL 5.5.1, 57 lines with 44A, 52A, 52B) and eight letters of the OB Sumerian epistolary curriculum that concern private life: 3.3.07 (Ugubi to his mother, 11), 3.3.06 (Aba-taḫ-lugalĝa to his brothers, 13), 3.3.01 (Ur-saga to a king, 14), 3.3.10 (Inanaka to Nintinuga, 26), 3.3.20 (Gudea to his personal god, 10), 3.3.08 (Šamaš-ṭāb to Ilak-niʾid, 19), 3.3.11 and 3.3.12 (Inim-Inana to Enlil-massu and Lugal-ibila, 15 + 13) – 178 lines. Not included: the royal correspondence of Ur (3.1.x) and the royal letter-prayers (3.2.x), which are political.

The Old Babylonian Akkadian private letters (AbB) were planned but not obtained: CDLI (`cdli.earth`) answered HTTP 503 all day (2026-10-21); Archibab is not on the allowlist; eBL's fragmentarium has OB letters but no searchable edition. A later run should take them (e.g. the letters of sons to mothers – Iddin-Sîn to Zinû, TCL 18 111 –, the Mari women, the Old Assyrian wives) from CDLI.

Base text

ETCSL (`../../sources/ETCSL/5.5.1--...`, `3.3.0N--...`, CC BY-NC-SA) with ORACC epsd2/literary Q000775, Q000573, Q000578, Q000579, Q000580, Q000582, Q000583, Q000584, Q000592 (lemma + morph). ETCSL's English is rank 3. Some letters carry Akkadian glosses in the manuscripts (`(gloss: ...)` in the transliteration): they are evidence for the ancient understanding and are translated in the apparatus.

Line numbering

ETCSL composite numbers (44A, 52A, 52B in 5.5.1 are pluses of single manuscripts). Files: `annotated-ludigira.rtl.md` (LUD), `annotated-letters.rtl.md` (the eight letters, units marked `<!-- unit: KEY -->`).

Formulas (renderings §3.3)

Opening *X-ra u_3-na-dug$_4$ / Y na-ab-be$_2$-a* = `אֶל X זֶה אֲשֶׁר / :אֱמֹר Y אוֹמֵר:`; closing *a-ma-ru-kam* = `מַבּוּל הוּא!`.

Open decisions

(Filled during drafting.)

Progress

(Filled per letter.)